



MONTHLY UPDATE

Djibouti: monthly update, August – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-08 · 15 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Summary of the month

The state's own records were the month's subject. [126 years of the Journal officiel were digitised and published online](#), under a letter of accord with the UN development agency signed on 2 August. Police body-worn cameras [are described as standard issue for the national police and road-safety officers](#), and no retention period, access rule, data controller or authorising instrument for the footage is published — a working surveillance capability with no instrument behind it.

On artificial intelligence the record moved to the policy side. The [first national strategy is to be launched at a national forum](#), alongside [a readiness assessment scoring the country 24.5 out of 100](#) — the first such measurement the base holds. Elsewhere an Italian mission [reported a submarine-cable inspection and protection project at the landing station on 3 August](#), and [a digital route connecting graduates with recruiters entered service](#). The urban rehabilitation agency's [complaint portal](#) is the first digital citizen-feedback channel the base holds, and it serves one agency.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

The interoperability framework acquired a statement of intent for the first time since it was published in 2022. The Council of Ministers' [2026 work programme of 1 September names paperless services and interoperability among the state-modernisation priorities](#). Nothing in it evidences the framework in use, and no system, timetable or budget is attached — so what has changed is that the government has said the word, not that anything is interoperable.

Data protection

On 4 August 2026 the state daily *La Nation* [described the Police Nationale and road-safety officers carrying body-worn cameras routinely in central Djibouti](#), not piloting them. The protocols it reports require the device to be worn visibly and the subject to be told they are being recorded, with recording triggered manually or automatically according to the type of intervention or the threat level detected. No retention period, access rule, data controller or authorising instrument is named, and nothing on file establishes one as at 4 August 2026. The Digital Code's prior-authorisation regime, in force since 30 June 2025, reaches biometric processing, and no authorisation or published rule covering the camera fleet is held.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

On 3 August 2026 the Italian foundation Med-Or reported that a [project promoted by Italy's foreign ministry with Med-Or is building the Djiboutian authorities' capability to inspect and protect the submarine cables](#), under a memorandum with the Ministry of Economy and Finance covering critical infrastructure, digital connectivity and strategic dialogue. [Med-Or's figures put 12 cables landing in Djibouti, six connected to Italy, and about 18% of international submarine cable data transiting the country](#). No amount, term or delivery date is stated and the memorandum is not held.

On 29 July the new communications minister [received Japan's ambassador and the UN resident coordinator in succession](#), covering audiovisual media re-equipment, journalist training against disinformation, and the strategic weight of the cables. No agreement was signed and no figure was given.

DPI

Data Exchange

Customs has begun preparing to put trade procedures on one platform. The administration [set out an electronic single-window project at a preparatory workshop on 1 September, saying it goes beyond strengthening the declaration system customs currently uses and would shorten processing times, increase transparency and make operations more predictable for traders](#), working with the commerce ministry, the continental free trade secretariat and a Korean agency that has done the same in three other African countries. No design, budget, procurement or timetable is published, and no baseline clearance time exists to measure the shortening against.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

On 2 August 2026 the Secrétariat général du Gouvernement and UNDP [signed a letter of accord to digitise the SGG's paper archives](#) — indexing, scanning, capacity building for national teams, and secure backup at the ANSIE data centre. [It follows a state-funded programme running since 2023 which the parties report has transferred several thousand archive boxes to the National Archives and produced over 200,000 secured digital files for the Presidency](#). From September 2026 it extends to the audit and integrity institutions — the Chambre des Comptes, the two financial inspectorates, the anti-corruption commission, the public accounts directorate and the human-rights commission. The accord's text, value and duration are not stated.

Technology

AI

On 17 July an upgraded AI weather early-warning system was [handed over at the World AI Conference in Shanghai](#). Version 2.0 adds observation and autonomous alerting through smart terminals combining satellite, ground data and forecast models, and sharpens forecast resolution to 3 km from 9 km. The first system was supplied by the China Meteorological Administration in July 2025 and entered service in December 2025.

The LinkWise interview of 23 July also [named a cross-border data corridor linking Shanghai to Djibouti among the arrangement's success indicators, alongside full Djiboutian jurisdiction over data natively generated on the territory](#), with chips specified as NVIDIA H and B series. The memorandum text is not held; the terms are the minister's account.

The national AI strategy that has been in preparation since January acquired a launch date, a shape and then a forum. Djibouti's first national artificial-intelligence forum [opened at the Palais du Peuple on the morning of 2 September under the President's patronage](#); the strategy was [set for official launch there](#), carried by the digital economy ministry and the Secretariat General of the Government with UNESCO and UN ESCWA support, and runs to 2032 on eight axes: ethical AI governance, data and digital infrastructure, education and human capital, economy and employment, social inclusion and gender, strategic sectors, responsible technological infrastructure, and international cooperation. The ministry [convened cross-ministerial focal points on 15 August](#) to coordinate it. Whether the text was in fact launched at the forum is not yet on the record.

The forum will also present the national readiness assessment behind the strategy, which puts Djibouti at [24.5 out of 100 on AI readiness against an ICT development index of 61.6](#) — the gap the strategy is written against, and one the account attributes to the submarine cables landing in Djibouti and the data centres built around them. Neither the assessment report nor the strategy text is held.

Capacity

Training and skills

Against unemployment, the state is [using digital channels to connect graduates with recruiters](#). The account names no platform, no registration count and no placement figure, so what is held is a stated direction rather than a measurable one. It is read here alongside the [spring economic monitor](#), whose school-to-work analysis is the closest thing the base holds to a measure of the problem the initiative is written against.

Inclusion

Access to services

The urban rehabilitation agency runs [a complaint-management portal that routes recovery and technical problems to named internal divisions](#). It is the only digital citizen-feedback channel the base holds, and it covers one agency's own business: no whole-of-government mechanism, service standard or complaint volume is published.

The corridor programme put training against formalisation rather than connectivity: [forty women traders took export-readiness training at Bishoftu on 30 and 31 July 2026 under a EUR 32m European corridor programme, covering business formalisation, product standards, export documentation and customs procedure](#). The training was delivered on the Ethiopian side of the corridor and no Djiboutian cohort, customs-system component or digital element is separately costed.

Data

Open data

The account of the archive programme published on 3 August also [establishes that 126 years of the Journal officiel are digitised and published online](#). The account gives no date for when publication began.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

A new impetus in digital and media cooperation between Djibouti and the United States was reported on 1 September 2026, with no instrument, sum or timetable published. What changed is that a bilateral digital relationship is on the record at all: the standing engagement until now was a hyperscaler's cable route that names Djibouti among its landings and has had no activation status published since 2021.

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